

After Tizen the smartphone, get set for Tizen-powered appliances!

Tizen definitely is one of the most ambitious projects from Samsung. Although its recently launched Tizen smartphone, Samsung Z1, has not done as well as expected in the market, Samsung is not willing to give up on this OS. According to the latest online reports, the company is willing to take its very own open source Tizen operating system beyond smartphones, to the world of appliances.



Samsung is reportedly planning to launch Tizen based smart refrigerators, air conditioners and washing machines, targeting Internet-connected homes, revealed a top executive of the company. Given the fact that the market of smartphones is getting increasingly saturated, the South Korean company is now diverting its resources into the domain of the Internet of Things (IoT), and Tizen-powered appliances will be a step in this direction.

Speaking to the reporters, B.K. Yoon, head of Samsung's consumer electronics unit, said that the company is already working on Tizen-powered TVs, refrigerators, air conditioners and other premium-priced home appliances, and will launch them this year. The company claims that the Tizen operating system is not restricted to just smartphones, but is good to connect home appliances and make them communicate with each other too.

Samsung is also planning to make all its new products Internet-connected by the year 2020, said the executive. In the *Times of India* report, Yoon was quoted as saying, "I think we have to make preparations for the IoT for future growth, as we previously grew in size by switching from... feature phones to smartphones." Samsung had unveiled its first-ever Tizen powered TVs at the recently concluded Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas. In a bid to strengthen its Internet-connected homes initiative, Samsung had acquired SmartThings, a US home automation start-up, last year.

Alpine Linux—a terminal-only Linux OS

An upgrade has been announced for Alpine Linux, which is a lightweight Linux distro mostly focused on security. Alpine Linux is based on *musl libc* and *Busybox*, which make up the terminal. The latest upgraded version is available for download now.

As mentioned on the official website, "The Alpine Linux project is pleased to announce the immediate availability of version 3.1.2 of its Alpine Linux operating system. This is a bug-fix release of the v3.1 *musl* based branch. This release is based on the 3.14.30 kernel which has some critical security fixes." The changelog shows that the new upgrade has implemented Docker 1.4.1, PHP version 5.6.4, Wine version 1.7.35 and also the latest OpenSSL package (1.0.1k). If you find the distro complicated, you can refer to the documentation, shared by the developer of the OS on his website.

VLC Media Player 3.0.0: One of the most anticipated apps of 2015

VLC Media Player is all set to launch version 3.0.0, which will have many new features and several improvements. This new edition is being eagerly awaited by millions of computer users across the globe. Some of the highlighted features of VLC 3.0.0 are support for Wayland, Chromecast output module, numerous Android improvements (like rotation, opaque and sub-picture blending) and batch convert support.



The upcoming release will also support ARIB STD-B24 subtitles, offer HEVC hardware decoding, improvements in the MMAL decoder, a new BPG decoder, better support for MPEG-DASH and a video filter which will allow conversion between FPS rates. Besides these, there will be support for SystemD Journal, OpenGL as default video output on GNU/Linux and BSD operating systems, HDS (HTTP Dynamic Streaming) support, DVB-T2 support, Daala video support, HD-DVD .evo support, Opus in MPEG Transport Stream, WMAV and WMV support in MP4/MOV and support for Mac OS X 10.10 Yosemite. There has been no word yet on when the final version will be available as not even a single RC has been released yet.